

CITA01 – Foundations of City Studies Summer 2026

July 6th, 2026

Course Instructor: Olivia Bernard

Planning
Theory and
Practice

Objectives

Final Exam
Structure

Indigenous
Placemaking

Assignment
2

Urban Design

Assignment 2

- July 27th, 2026
- Worth 20%



Final Exam



8 QUESTIONS,
CHOOSE 6



CASE STUDIES



2 HOURS – EXACT
TIME TBA

What is Urban Planning?



Urban Planning

Urban planning is concerned with shaping the built, natural, and social environment in communities large and small for the public good.

“Planning theory is shaped by local planning cultures based on the history and level of development in the country and the unique social, economic, and cultural forces at play”. P.431

Urban Planning and the Work of Planners

- Planners (ideally) work for the **public good**;
- The objective is to temper market rationality with social considerations;
- Planners **promote long-term visions** in debates about urban form and futures;
- They do this in **different roles**: policy-makers, public servants, city-builders, community organizers, consultants, and political activists;
- Although the built environment has been a central concern for planners, **they also take into account social, economic and cultural issues.**

City Planning

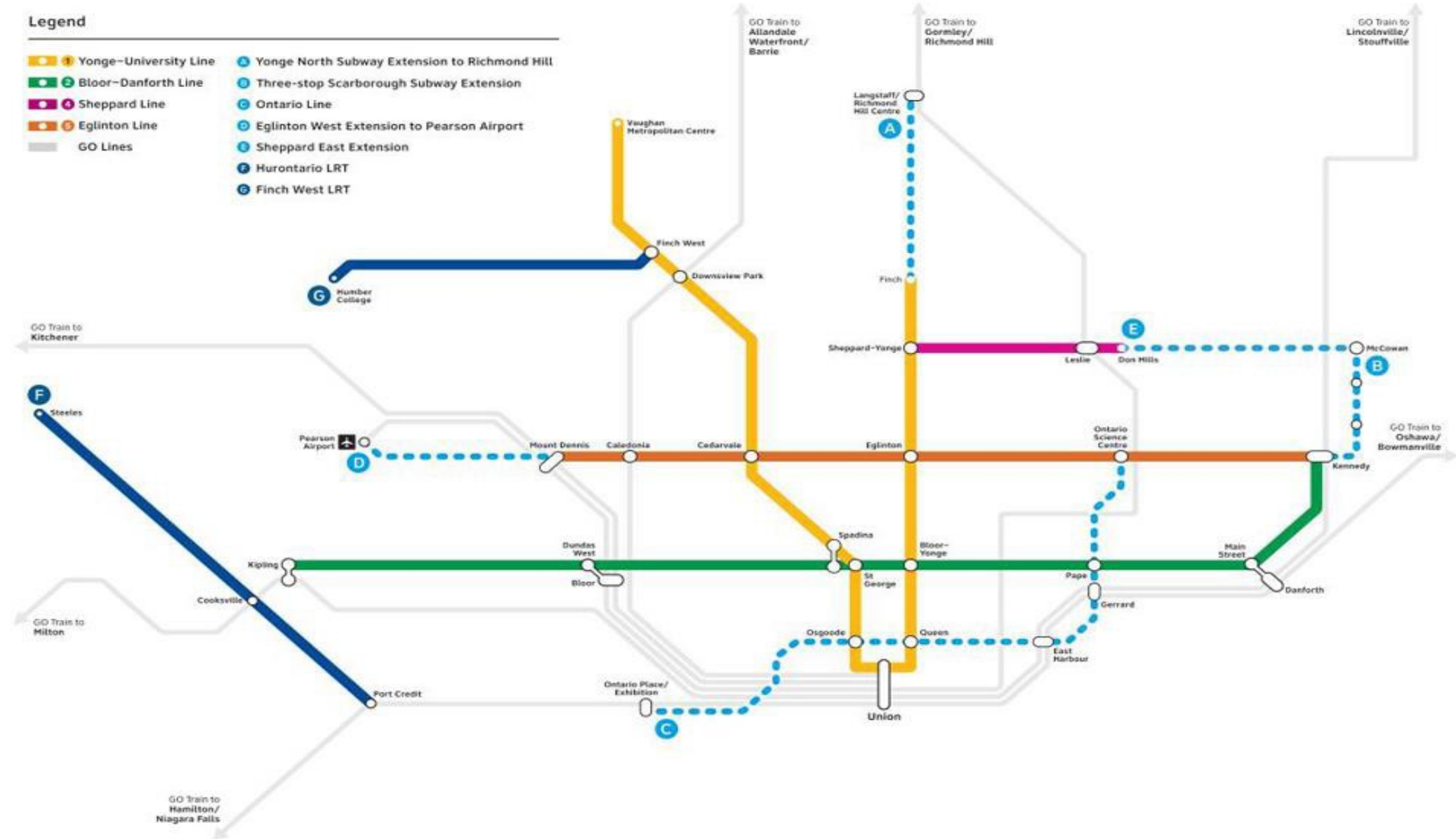
The City Planning Division is helping to build Toronto's future by managing the growth and physical form of the city – how it looks, feels, and moves, and the opportunities it provides in terms of jobs and services to its residents.

City Planning works with stakeholders and other City divisions to set goals and policies for responsible development. It provides support and advice to City Council to help to ensure that Toronto's growth contributes to the kind of communities and neighbourhoods Torontonians want.

The division also reviews and processes development approval applications from a community planning and an urban design perspective. City Planning staff gather public input and conduct research to develop and review plans, regulations and projects that protect and enhance our urban environment.

Legend

- Yonge-University Line
- Bloor-Danforth Line
- Sheppard Line
- Eglinton Line
- GO Lines
- Yonge North Subway Extension to Richmond Hill
- Three-stop Scarborough Subway Extension
- Ontario Line
- Eglinton West Extension to Pearson Airport
- Sheppard East Extension
- Hurontario LRT
- Finch West LRT



The Origins and Progression of Urban Planning

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context.scene.objects.active  
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print("please select exactly  
one mirror")
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--- OPERATOR CLASSES ---

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bpy.types.Operator):  
    X mirror to the selected  
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    mirror X"
```


HISTORICAL SHIFTS IN THE WAY THE PLANNER HAS BEEN CONCEIVED



1. From creative designer to scientific analyst and rational decision-maker.



2. From technical expert to manager, facilitator and “communicator.”

Academic City Planning – Early 20th Century

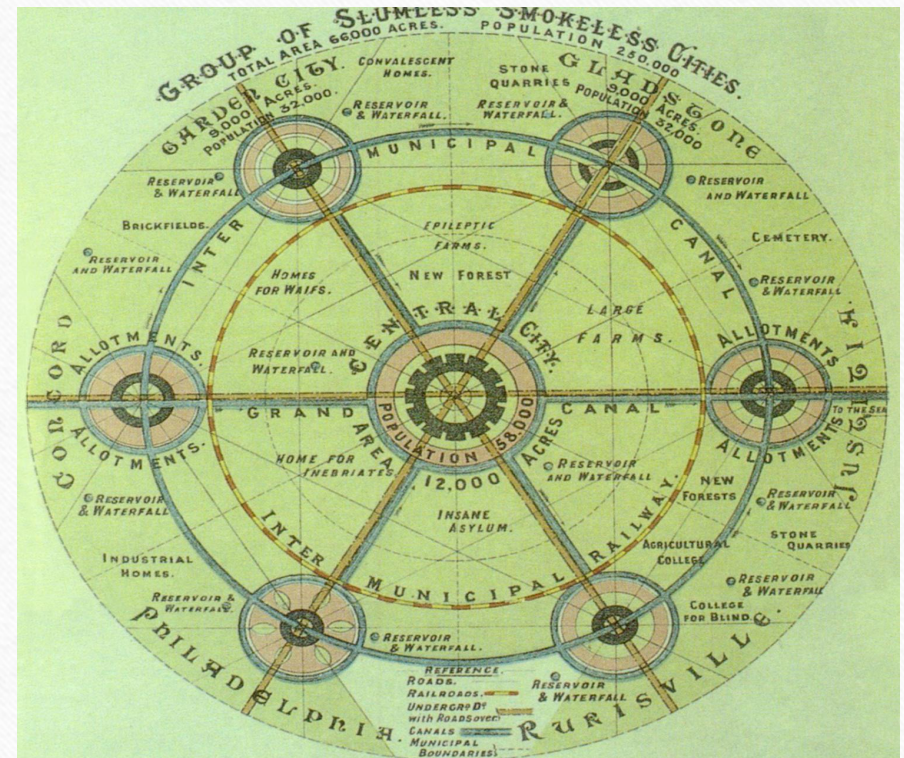
- Urban planning was defined as the craft before the second world war
- “Professors who had been educated as architects dominated urban planning teaching and writing. The first generation of planning professors taught students to prepare architectural drawings extended to city scale – particularly self-contained”
- “Planners were viewed as a privileged elite and were not expected to interact with the people for whom they were planning”.
- Mainly architects and Engineers were urban planners at this time

Academic City Planning – Early 20th Century

- “The job of the planners was to make plans, to develop codes to enforce these plans, and then to enforce those codes; relevant planning knowledge was what was needed for that job; planning education existed to convey that knowledge together with the necessary design skills”
- “The goals were left implicit; **the planner would develop them intuitively from his own values**, which by definition were “expert” and apolitical”
- “**The ideal city would be a static, stable city**” – p.435

Garden City Movement

- Ebenezer Howard – 1898 - designed a garden city model based on the following principles:
 1. Each garden city would be limited in size to 32,000 population.
 2. It would have sufficient jobs to make it self-supporting.
 3. It would have a diversity of activities, including social institutions.
 4. Its layout would be spacious.
 5. It would have a green belt to provide agricultural produce, recreation space and a limit to physical growth.
- These garden cities would be built to improve people's quality of life in cities



Urban Planning and the Parks Movement



Fredrick Law Olmsted is remembered as the father of the American public park movement.

- He advocated for **wider streets and parks** to promote the wellbeing of citizens
- Improvements in public health through **sanitation**, access to clean air, trees etc.
- The need to combat “urban vice and social degeneration;” Disease and crime rates are higher than rural areas
- **Advancing civilization through the provision of urban amenities available to all.** Parks foster community, wellbeing and communal gatherings
- Trees act as air purifiers and are necessary to provide **relief from stressors** in the urban environment
- Without proper urban planning, Olmsted believes the growth of urban areas will lead to increased social and health issues - **Central Park in New York, Mont Royal Park in Montreal** etc.

Model City of Mount Royal - Quebec

- Created by architect Fredrick Gage Todd in 1914 and built in phases until 1970s.
- Created with influences from the City Beautiful, Garden City and others at the time – an example of a planned community in Canada.
- **“The Model City of Mount Royal was created as a response to industrialization and big-city problems that plagued large metropolitan centres during the late 19th and early 20th centuries, as part of the urban renewal movement carried on in large Canadian cities by landscape architects” Parks Canada**
- **City Beautiful Movement** - the curving and straight-lined plots, and the broad boulevards lined with institutions and apartment buildings leading to the central public square
- **Garden City** – integration of the railway, the separation of the functional zones within the city, the distinction between residential streets and the main arterials



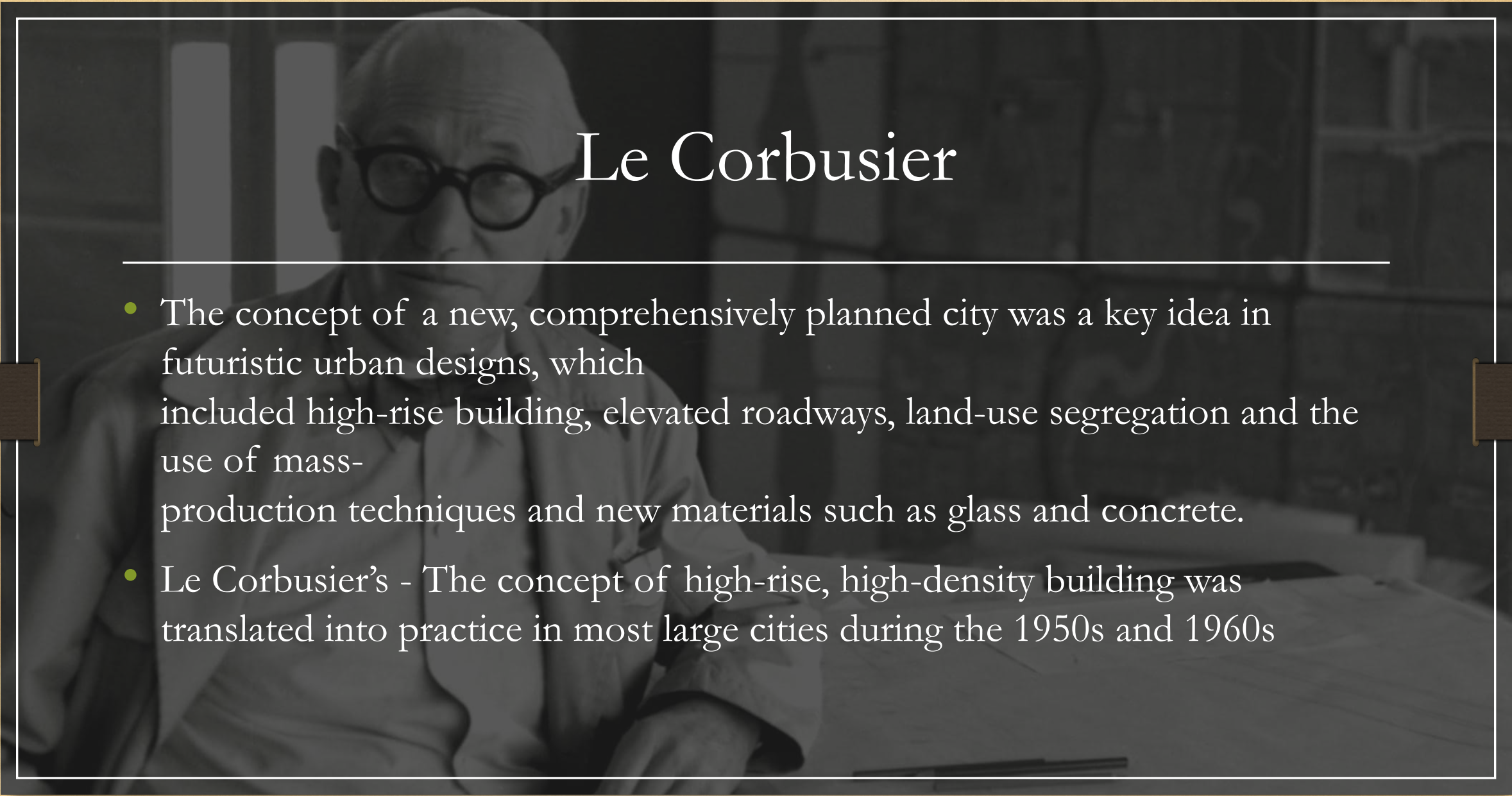
The Systems Revolution

The 1940s baby boom changed how planning was approached.

The new demand for child rearing facilities, homes and cars meant new strategies had to be created. Planners did not expect this.

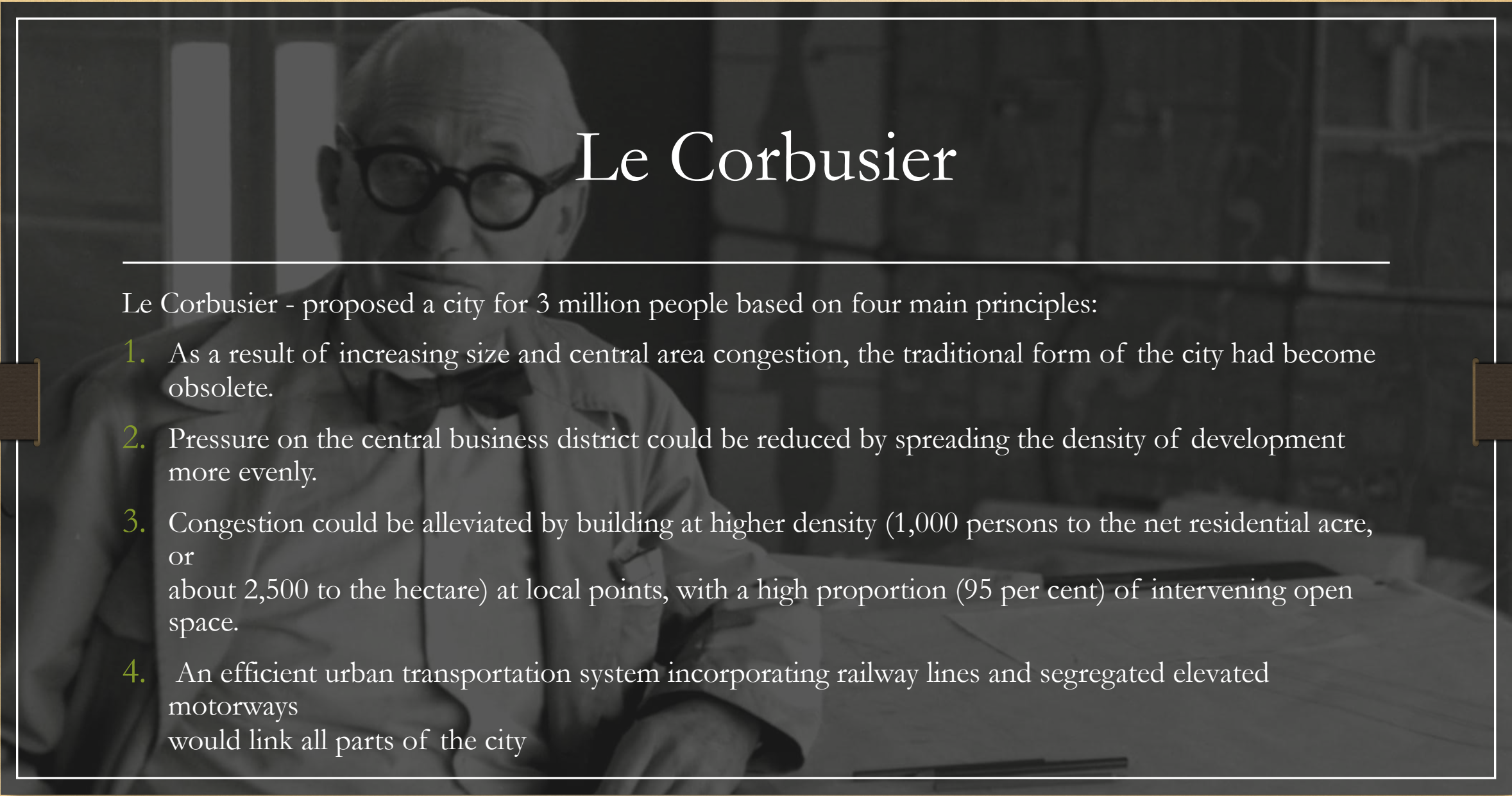
The Systems Revolution

- Both of those factors brought on the systems revolution – quantitative planning beginning in the **1960s**
- “The subject changed from a kind of craft, based on personal knowledge of a rudimentary collection of concepts about the city, into an **apparently scientific activity in which vast amounts of precise information were garnered and processed in such a way that the planner could devise very sensitive systems of guidance and control**, the effects of which could be monitored and if necessary modified”
- “**Cities and regions were viewed as complex systems** – they were, indeed, only a particular spatially based subset of a whole general class of systems – while planning was seen as a continuous process of control and monitoring of these systems, derived from the then new science” – p.437
- Examples were transportation planning, division of land, building of roads and parks.



Le Corbusier

- The concept of a new, comprehensively planned city was a key idea in futuristic urban designs, which included high-rise building, elevated roadways, land-use segregation and the use of mass-production techniques and new materials such as glass and concrete.
- Le Corbusier's - The concept of high-rise, high-density building was translated into practice in most large cities during the 1950s and 1960s



Le Corbusier

Le Corbusier - proposed a city for 3 million people based on four main principles:

1. As a result of increasing size and central area congestion, the traditional form of the city had become obsolete.
2. Pressure on the central business district could be reduced by spreading the density of development more evenly.
3. Congestion could be alleviated by building at higher density (1,000 persons to the net residential acre, or about 2,500 to the hectare) at local points, with a high proportion (95 per cent) of intervening open space.
4. An efficient urban transportation system incorporating railway lines and segregated elevated motorways would link all parts of the city

Marxist Theory and the Right to the City

- Let us recall - What is the right to the city?
- Beginning in the 1970s, Marxist strategies became influential in how urban areas were planned
- It viewed city planning as an ongoing, fluid, messy process.
- Effective urban planning requires planners to interact with citizens – **no more top-down approach**
- Planners must content with what kind of city they are planning and **for whom.**
- Urban planning should be used as a “**vehicle that could benefit poor and powerless people rather than serve the interests of established business elites, pro-growth local governments and self-serving suburbanites intent on excluding low-income and minority households**”

Do we believe capital and neoliberal ideals
should have greater influence in urban
planning? What is the importance of the state?

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    description="Mirror X"
```


The Role of the State in Urban Planning – Marxist Theory

Capital “tries to achieve certain necessary objectives: **to facilitate continued capital accumulation**, by ensuring rational allocation of resources; by assisting the reproduction of the labour force through provision of social services, thus maintaining a delicate balance between labour and capital and preventing social disintegration; and by guaranteeing and legitimating capitalist social and property relations” – p.441

“In particular, it seeks to guarantee collective **provision of necessary infrastructure and certain basic urban services**, and to reduce negative externalities whereby certain activities of capital cause losses to other parts of the system”. –p.441

Urban Planning and Marxist theory

- “Davidoff ’s advocacy planning of fifteen years before: cultivate community networks, listen carefully to the people, involve the less-organized groups, educate the citizens in how to join in, supply information and make sure people know how to get it, develop skills in working with groups in conflict situations, emphasize the need to participate, compensate for external pressures” – P.443

Great Smog of London

In December of 1952, there was a severe air pollution catastrophe that affected London, England.

The smog lasted from December 5th to December 9th and was caused by foggy weather conditions and pollution from factories – coal as an energy source

Roughly 12000 people died during this time, though it was previously projected at 4000

This event and how it was handled by Winston Churchill led to a shift in planning with a greater focus on protecting the environment – Creating the Clean Air Act of 1956



Break - 5 Minutes

Old Penn Station – Urban Planning

<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=-41Eh7fnjO0>



Important Values in Planning

Economic
values

Aesthetic
values

Political values

Social values

Cultural values

Environmental
values

Urban Planning and Settler Colonization

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mirror object to mirror  
mirror_mod.mirror_object
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Settler Colonialization

- Settler colonialism refers to the dispossession of Indigenous lands, displacement of Indigenous peoples and ongoing acts of violence to cement colonial powers within a nation.
- Settler colonialism is based on the theft of land and resources, and elimination of Indigenous peoples as central logics driving the process
- Canadian laws, enacted by various levels of government has been one of the main tools used in settler colonialism, to displace Indigenous people's rights and lands.

Dorries, 2022; Tomiak, 2017

Urban Planning and Settler Cities

- Urban Planning was central to producing segregation through the creation of new districts/areas
- Areas were demarcated into Indigenous vs European spaces/towns
- The colonial processes of urban design have sought to replace Indigenous places with settler colonial landscapes and cityscapes where racially coded legacies continue to generate contests over the ownership and belonging of space
- Planning, according to Nejad et al, reproduce colonial ideologies and practices that invisibilize Indigenous communities

Indigeneity and Urban Planning

- 52% of the Indigenous population lives in Canada's cities
- These cities are located on Indigenous traditional territories and homelands.
- The Truth and Reconciliation Commission of Canada has called upon municipal governments to deconstruct Eurocentric concepts and procedures that have imposed settler-colonial sovereignty over Indigenous peoples and their territories
- “Canadian Institute of Planners... encourages urban planners to enhance their professional practice by increasing their awareness of Indigenous protocols, cultural frameworks, and planning methods”. – p434
- This is meant to forge meaningful relationships between urban Planners and Indigenous people – mutual respect, trust and dialogue

Indigeneity and Urban Planning

Settler colonial cities like Toronto attempted to displace Indigeneity from urban spaces, invisibilizing their presence.

In order for planners in colonial cities to be seen as centres of civilization, Eurocentric productions of space were used to illustrate the land as both empty and void of development.

Nejad et al states that maps, surveys and the drawing of borders etc were used to position Indigenous people as being outside of urban areas – followed by the development of architecture and how urban areas were/are designed

Indigeneity and Urban Planning

- When we think of urban planning and the creation of urban area, we must think about it in relation to settler colonialism – dispossession and marginalization of Indigenous peoples
- Those who have a say in how places are created and maintained have the ability to exert power, domination and control
- “The colonial processes of urban planning and design have re-territorialized urban space in ways that subordinate the Indigenous sense of place, superimposing Western epistemologies of placemaking upon it”. – p.434

Urban Planning and Right to the City

As we can recall from earlier, the right to the city maintain that we should include minority groups in urban design. Allow them to participate in planning practices



For Indigenous people who are the original inhabitants of the land, do we think this should be the same or a bit different?

Indigenous Placemaking

- Indigenous placemaking creates a sense of place for Indigenous peoples living in cities, fulfilling the right to self-determination, land-based claims, and creating a sense of shared Indigenous space for non-Indigenous inhabitants.
- Placemaking should be a collaborative process toward reconciliation to create places that restore Indigenous visibility in Canadian society and project Indigenous identity, worldviews, and values
- Unmediated participation of Indigenous peoples in urban design processes according to their own knowledge, approaches, and methods

Indigenous Placemaking

Incorporate recent presence and contribution of Indigenous peoples to urban society...The effort should not begin and end with putting Indigenous cultural artefacts in galleries". p.438

Placemaking through **naming public spaces, Indigenous public art, and architecture**, can help to reclaim symbolic significance of original occupancy and acknowledgment of traditional Indigenous territories

"Indigenous communities decide what should be presented, how it is designed, and where it is placed; it is not limited to design and programming by officials in city planning and administration offices, with Indigenous input"

Examples



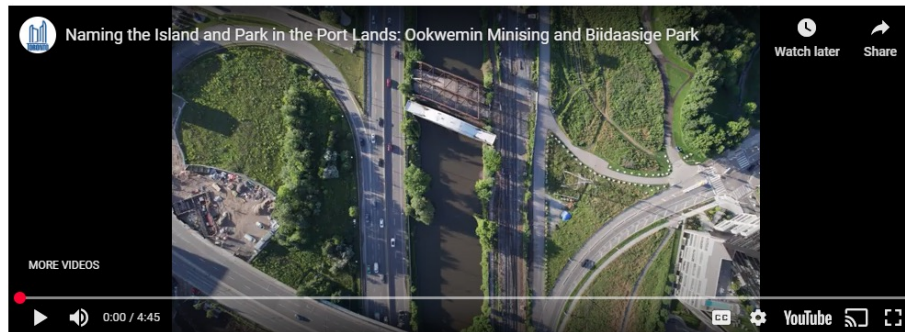
Monument honouring missing and murdered Indigenous women and girls at The Forks, Winnipeg, Canada. A joint project by Ka Ni Kanichihk Inc. and the Province of Manitoba.

Examples

- The Coming Spring, a sculpture in Saskatoon to represent the relationships between First Nations, Métis, and settler peoples, and to remember the children who suffered in the residential school system.
- A joint project of the Saskatoon Tribal Council, City of Saskatoon, Office of the Treaty Commissioner, Central Urban Métis Federation, and Government of Canada



Port Lands Indigenous Place Naming Initiative



On November 1, 2024, Mayor Olivia Chow and Councillor Paula Fletcher (Toronto-Danforth) were joined by Elder Shelley Charles (Chippewas of Georgina Island First Nation) and members of the Indigenous Advisory Circle to announce the name Ookwemin Minising [Oh-kway-min Min-nih-sing], for the new island now formed in the Port Lands. The circle has also chosen Biidaasige [Bee-daw-sih-geh] for the new park that surrounds the island. City Council approved the names on November 13, 2024, responding to [EX18.3](#) with the [staff report](#) with the new names and [Engagement Summary](#) on the process.

City of Toronto staff collaborated with [LURA](#) and [MinoKamik Collective](#) on an Indigenous community engagement process to discover, reflect on and determine Indigenous place names for “Villiers Island,” the parkland and connecting streets.

In April 2024, [\(EX13.5\)](#) Executive Committee and City Council directed the Waterfront Secretariat and Indigenous Affairs

Examples

- https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=TQ_5A-IIqeA

Discussion

- Please check the tab under the materials for this week on the modules page.
- Upload by the end of class - 1pm.
- Please respond in 150 – 250 words.
- Discuss a concrete example from today's lecture of how urban planners can collaborate with Indigenous peoples to reflect strong Indigenous placemaking in settler cities. What is an impact that this would have on urban design?

Next Steps

Reflections on Urban Design

- Jacobs, Jane 2015 [1961] “The Uses of Sidewalks: Safety.” Pp. 149-153 in The City Reader.
- Whyte, William H. 2015 [1988] The Design of Spaces. Pp. 587-595 in The City Reader

